with regard to the choice of the base year, the method of selection of items, preparation of weighting diagram and the collection of prices. The new index along with the base year and the commodity basket was also examined by Technical Advisory Committee (TAC) on Prices and Cost of Living based in Central Statistical Organisation. Before the launch of the new index, inter-departmental consultations were held and opinions obtained from Economic Advisory Council of the Prime Minister.

A comparative statement of weights, number of items and number of quotations between the **old series** and **new series** at Group level is as below:

Major Group / Group	*Weight*		*No. of items*		*No. of Quotations*	
	2004–05	*1993–94*	*2004–05*	*1993–94*	*2004–05*	*1993–94*
All Commodities	100.00	100.00	676	435	5482	1918
Primary Articles	20.12	22.02	102	98	579	455
Fuel & Power	14.91	14.23	19	19	72	72
Manufactured Products	64.97	63.75	555	318	4831	1391

Many new items have been included in the new series basket such as flowers, lemon and crude petroleum in **Primary Articles** and Ice cream, canned meat, palm oil, readymade/instant food powder, mineral water, computer stationary, leather products, scooter / motorcycle tyre, polymers, petrochemical intermediates, granites, marbles, gold and silver, construction machinery, refrigerators, computers, dish antenna, transformer, microwave oven, communication equipments (telephone instruments), TV sets, VCD, washing machine and auto parts in **Manufactured Products**. A complete list of commodity basket including their weights in the new series of WPI with the base 2004-05 is available on the website www.eaindustry.nic.in.

Revised Series: New Initiatives

There has been a substantial increase, both in terms of the number of commodities and its geographical coverage, in the revised series of WPI (base 2004–05=100), as compared to the earlier revisions undertaken so